implementation of several international conventions on nature conservation and biodiversity.

Red Data Book

Red Data book or Red list is a catalogue of taxa facing risk of extinction. IUCN – International Union of Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources, which is renamed as WCU – World Conservation Union (Morges Switzerland) maintains the Red Data book. The concept of Red list was mooted in 1963. The purpose of preparation of Red List are:

- To create awareness on the degree of threat to biodiversity
- Identification and documentation of species at high risk of extinction
- Provide global index on declining biodiversity
- Preparing conservation priorities and help in conservation of action
- Information on international agreements on conservation of biological diversity

Red list has eight categories of species i) Extinct ii) Extinct in wild iii) Critically Endangered iv) Endangered v) Vulnerable vi) Lower risk vii) Data deficiency viii) Not evaluated.

11.7 Biodiversity and its conservation

The natural resources of the Earth, including air, water, land, flora and fauna of natural ecosystems must be safeguarded for the benefit of the present and future generations through careful planning and management, as appropriate – Principle of the Stockholm Declaration, 1972.

The large-scale loss of biodiversity and its global impact makes conservation the need of the hour.

Conservation of biodiversity is protection and scientific management of biodiversity so as to maintain it at its optimum level and derive sustainable benefits for the present as well as future generations. It aims to protect species from extinction and their habitats and ecosystems from degradation.

General strategies in conservation

- identify and protect all threatened species
- identify and conserve in protected areas the wild relatives of all the economically important organisms
- identify and protect critical habitats for feeding, breeding, nursing, resting of each species
- resting, feeding and breeding places of the organisms should be identified and protected
- air, water and soil should be conserved on priority basis
- wildlife Protection Act should be implemented

There are two aspects of conservation strategies **(Table 11.4).**

i) *In-situ* conservation
ii) *Ex-situ* conservation

11.7.1 *In-situ* Conservation
(Conservation in the natural habitat)

This is the conservation of genetic resources through their protection within a natural or manmade ecosystem in which they occur. It is conservation and protection of the whole ecosystem and its biodiversity at all levels in order to protect the threatened species.

Maximum protection of biodiversity hotspots regions with very high levels of species richness. Although all the biodiversity hotspots

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